

**ST. FRANCIS OF ASSISI PRIVATE
SCHOOL**

**ACCOUNTS MODULE
USER GUIDE**

Including Student Fees Integration

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1. Introduction to the Accounts Module

The Accounts Module is the central financial management system for St. Francis Of Assisi Private School. It provides comprehensive tools for managing all school finances, from daily transactions to complex financial reporting.

1.1 Purpose

The Accounts Module serves the following purposes:

- Record and track all financial transactions
- Integrate with Student Fees for automatic income recording
- Manage multiple bank accounts
- Process and approve payment vouchers
- Generate financial reports for management and auditors
- Maintain complete audit trails for compliance

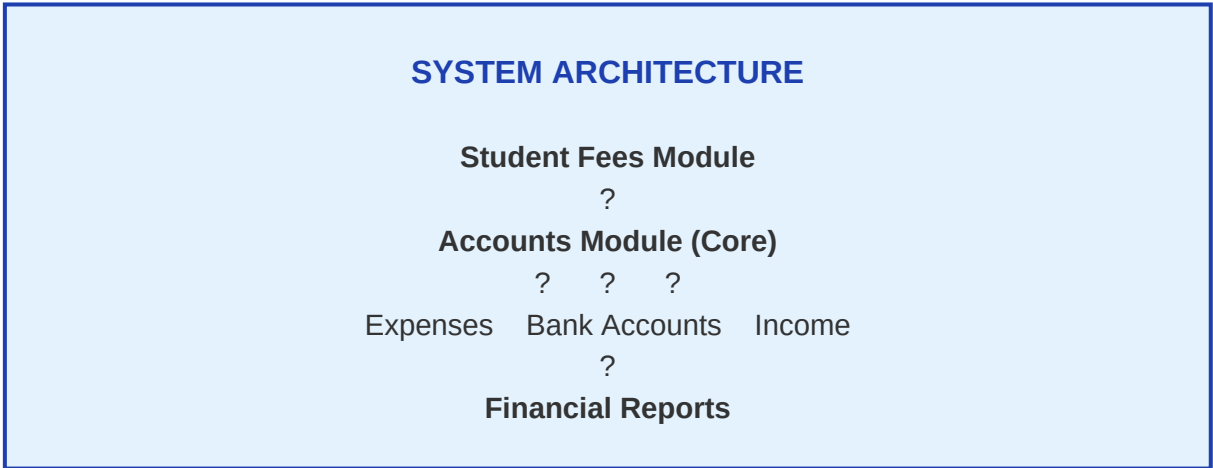
1.2 Key Benefits

Benefit	Description
Automation	Fee payments automatically create income records and journal entries
Accuracy	Double-entry accounting ensures balanced books
Transparency	Complete audit trail for every transaction
Efficiency	Streamlined workflows reduce manual work
Reporting	Real-time financial reports at your fingertips

2. System Overview and Architecture

The Accounts Module is built on a modular architecture that integrates seamlessly with other school management modules, particularly the Student Fees system.

2.1 System Components



2.2 Module Integration Points

Module	Integration Type	Data Flow
Student Fees	Automatic	Fee payments ? Income records ? Journal entries
HR/Payroll	Semi-automatic	Salary data ? Expense records ? Payment vouchers
Inventory	Manual	Purchase orders ? Expenses ? Payments
Reporting	Real-time	All transactions ? Financial statements

3. Student Fees and Accounts Integration

IMPORTANT: This is a key integration point

Student fee payments are the primary source of school income. Understanding how fees flow into the accounts system is essential for accurate financial management.

3.1 How Fee Payments Flow to Accounts

When a student fee payment is recorded, the following automatic processes occur:

Step	Action	Description
Step 1	Payment Entry	Bursar/Cashier enters fee payment in Student Fees module
Step 2	Validation	System validates student, fee type, and amount
Step 3	Receipt Generation	Fee receipt is generated for the parent/student
Step 4	Income Record	AUTOMATIC: Income record created in Accounts module
Step 5	Journal Entry	AUTOMATIC: Double-entry journal created (Debit: Bank, Credit: Fee Income)
Step 6	Bank Balance Update	Bank account balance updated in real-time
Step 7	Reports Updated	All financial reports reflect the new payment

3.2 Fee Categories and Account Mapping

Each fee category is mapped to a specific income account in the Chart of Accounts:

Fee Category	Account Code	Account Name	Type
Tuition Fees	4010	Tuition Income	Revenue
Boarding Fees	4020	Boarding Income	Revenue

Transport Fees	4030	Transport Income	Revenue
Lunch Fees	4040	Lunch Program Income	Revenue
Uniform Sales	4050	Uniform Sales	Revenue
Exam Fees	4060	Examination Fees	Revenue
Registration	4070	Registration Income	Revenue
Other Fees	4090	Miscellaneous Income	Revenue

3.3 Journal Entry Example

When a student pays K5,000 tuition via bank deposit:

Account	Debit (ZMW)	Credit (ZMW)
1020 - Bank Account	5,000.00	-
4010 - Tuition Income	-	5,000.00
TOTAL	5,000.00	5,000.00

TIP: Automatic vs Manual

Fee payments create automatic journal entries. Manual income (donations, grants) must be recorded separately through the Income module. Both appear in financial reports.

4. Chart of Accounts

The Chart of Accounts is the foundation of the accounting system. It organizes all financial accounts into categories following standard accounting principles.

4.1 Account Categories

Code Range	Category	Normal Balance	Examples
1000s	Assets	Debit	Cash, Bank, Receivables, Equipment
2000s	Liabilities	Credit	Payables, Loans, Accrued Expenses
3000s	Equity	Credit	Capital, Retained Earnings
4000s	Revenue	Credit	Fees, Donations, Grants
5000s	Expenses	Debit	Salaries, Utilities, Supplies

4.2 Standard Account List

Code	Account Name	Type	Balance
1010	Petty Cash	Asset	Debit
1020	Main Bank Account	Asset	Debit
1030	Payroll Bank Account	Asset	Debit
1100	Accounts Receivable - Students	Asset	Debit
1500	Fixed Assets - Buildings	Asset	Debit
2010	Accounts Payable	Liability	Credit
2100	PAYE Payable	Liability	Credit
2110	NAPSA Payable	Liability	Credit
3000	School Capital	Equity	Credit
4010	Tuition Income	Revenue	Credit
4020	Boarding Income	Revenue	Credit

5010	Teacher Salaries	Expense	Debit
5100	Electricity Expense	Expense	Debit
5110	Water Expense	Expense	Debit

5. Bank Account Management

The system supports multiple bank accounts, allowing you to track all financial activities across different banks and account types.

5.1 Setting Up a Bank Account

- 1. Navigate to Accounts ? Bank Accounts
- 2. Click "New Bank Account"
- 3. Enter bank name (e.g., "Zanaco", "Stanbic")
- 4. Enter account number
- 5. Select account type (Current/Savings)
- 6. Enter opening balance
- 7. Check "Default" if this is the primary operating account
- 8. Link to Chart of Accounts entry (e.g., 1020 - Main Bank Account)
- 9. Click "Save"

5.2 Bank Transaction Types

Transaction	Description	Balance Effect
Deposit	Money received into account	Increases balance (+)
Withdrawal	Money taken from account	Decreases balance (-)
Transfer Out	Money sent to another account	Decreases balance (-)
Transfer In	Money received from another account	Increases balance (+)
Bank Charge	Fees deducted by bank	Decreases balance (-)
Interest	Interest earned on account	Increases balance (+)

6. Expense Management

6.1 Recording an Expense

- 1. Navigate to Accounts ? Expenses
- 2. Click "New Expense"
- 3. Enter or accept auto-generated expense number
- 4. Select expense date
- 5. Choose expense category (Utilities, Supplies, etc.)
- 6. Select vendor or add new
- 7. Enter description of goods/services
- 8. Enter amount
- 9. Attach supporting documents (invoice, receipt)
- 10. Set payment status (Paid/Partially Paid/Unpaid)
- 11. Click "Save"

6.2 Expense Categories

Category	Examples
Personnel	Salaries, allowances, benefits, training
Facilities	Rent, electricity, water, maintenance, repairs
Academic	Textbooks, lab supplies, teaching materials
Administrative	Office supplies, printing, postage, communication
Transport	Fuel, vehicle maintenance, driver allowances
Food Services	Food supplies, kitchen equipment, catering
Professional	Audit fees, legal fees, consulting
Capital	Furniture, computers, building improvements

6.3 Expense Approval Limits

Amount (ZMW)	Approval Authority	Documentation
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0 - 1,000	Accountant	Receipt only
1,001 - 5,000	Senior Accountant	Invoice + Receipt
5,001 - 20,000	Finance Manager	2 Quotations + Invoice
20,001 - 50,000	School Director	3 Quotations + Invoice
Above 50,000	Board of Directors	Tender process required

7. Income Recording

Income is recorded from two sources: automatic fee payments and manual income entries.

7.1 Automatic Income (From Fees)

Student fee payments are automatically recorded. No manual entry required. The system:

- Creates income record linked to the student
- Generates journal entry (Debit: Bank, Credit: Income)
- Updates bank balance in real-time
- Tags income with fee category for reporting

7.2 Manual Income Entry

For non-fee income (donations, grants, facility rentals):

1. Navigate to Accounts ? Income Records
2. Click "New Income"
3. Select income category
4. Enter received date
5. Enter amount
6. Select payment method (Cash/Bank/Mobile Money)
7. Enter reference number
8. Add description or notes
9. Attach supporting documents if applicable
10. Click "Save"

8. Payment Vouchers

Payment vouchers provide formal authorization for payments. They ensure proper approval, documentation, and audit trail for every financial outflow.

8.1 Creating a Payment Voucher

1. Navigate to Accounts > Payment Vouchers
2. Click "New Payment Voucher"
3. System auto-generates voucher number (e.g., PV-2024-0001)
4. Select payee (vendor or individual)
5. Enter payment purpose/description
6. Add line items with amounts
7. Attach supporting documents (invoice, quotations)
8. Select bank account for payment
9. Choose payment method (Cheque/Bank Transfer/Cash)
10. Submit for approval

8.2 Voucher Approval Workflow

PAYMENT VOUCHER WORKFLOW

Create > Submit > Verify > Approve > Process Payment > Mark Paid
(Accountant) > (Sr. Accountant) > (Finance Mgr) > (Cashier) > (Accountant)

8.3 Voucher Status

Status	Description	Next Action
Draft	Voucher being prepared	Complete and submit
Pending	Awaiting approval	Approver reviews
Approved	Ready for payment	Process payment
Paid	Payment completed	Archive
Rejected	Approval denied	Review and revise

9. Bank Reconciliation

Bank reconciliation ensures your system records match the bank statement. This critical process should be performed monthly for each bank account.

9.1 Reconciliation Steps

- 1. Obtain bank statement for the period
- 2. Navigate to Accounts > Bank Reconciliation
- 3. Select bank account to reconcile
- 4. Enter statement ending date
- 5. Enter statement ending balance
- 6. Review system transactions for the period
- 7. Match each transaction with statement entries
- 8. Identify deposits in transit (in system, not on statement)
- 9. Identify outstanding cheques (issued but not cleared)
- 10. Record any bank charges or interest not in system
- 11. Verify reconciled balance matches statement
- 12. Complete and save reconciliation
- 13. Print reconciliation report

9.2 Common Reconciling Items

Item	Description	Action
Deposits in Transit	Recorded but not yet in bank	Will clear next period
Outstanding Cheques	Issued but not yet cashed	Monitor for stale cheques
Bank Charges	Fees deducted by bank	Record as expense
Interest Earned	Interest credited by bank	Record as income
Direct Debits	Automatic payments	Verify and record
Errors	Recording mistakes	Correct immediately

10. Financial Reports

10.1 Available Reports

Report	Purpose	Frequency
Income & Expense	Summary of all revenue and costs	Monthly
Cash Flow Statement	Money movements in/out	Weekly/Monthly
Expense by Category	Detailed expense breakdown	Monthly
Income by Category	Detailed income breakdown	Monthly
Outstanding Payables	Unpaid vendor amounts	Weekly
Trial Balance	Account balances verification	Monthly
Fee Collection	Student fee payments summary	Daily/Weekly

10.2 Generating Reports

1. Navigate to Accounts ? Financial Reports
2. Select report type from dropdown
3. Choose date range (start and end dates)
4. Apply additional filters if needed
5. Click "Generate Report"
6. Review on screen
7. Click "Export PDF" to download

11. Security and Access Control

11.1 User Roles

Role	Permissions
Accountant	Record transactions, create vouchers, generate reports, bank reconciliation
Sr. Accountant	All accountant permissions + approve vouchers up to K10,000 + manage vendors
Finance Manager	All permissions + approve all vouchers + modify Chart of Accounts + user management
Auditor	View-only access to all records, reports, and audit logs
Director	High-level approval authority + dashboard access + all reports

11.2 Security Best Practices

- ? Never share your login credentials with anyone
- ? Change your password every 90 days
- ? Use strong passwords (12+ characters, mixed case, numbers, symbols)
- ? Log out when leaving your workstation
- ? Report suspicious activity immediately
- ? Do not access the system from public computers
- ? Verify requests for payment changes via phone call

12. Daily and Monthly Procedures

12.1 Daily Checklist

- ? Review dashboard for financial overview
- ? Process pending payment vouchers
- ? Record all cash receipts
- ? Verify fee payments have been recorded
- ? Check bank account balances
- ? Respond to any approval requests
- ? Back up critical documents

12.2 Weekly Checklist

- ? Generate cash flow report
- ? Review outstanding payables
- ? Follow up on pending collections
- ? Verify petty cash balance
- ? Review expense documentation
- ? Check for any reconciliation items

12.3 Monthly Checklist

- ? Complete bank reconciliation for all accounts
- ? Generate monthly financial reports
- ? Review budget vs actual spending
- ? Process payroll-related expenses
- ? Submit statutory returns (PAYE, NAPSA)
- ? Archive monthly records
- ? Submit reports to management

13. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q: How do I correct a wrongly recorded transaction?

A: Do not delete the transaction. Instead, create a reversing entry with the same amount but opposite effect (debit becomes credit). Then record the correct transaction. This maintains audit trail integrity.

Q: Why are fee payments not showing in my income reports?

A: Fee payments are automatically recorded when processed through the Student Fees module. Check: (1) The payment was saved successfully, (2) The date range of your report includes the payment date, (3) The fee category is included in your filter.

Q: Can I edit an approved payment voucher?

A: No. Once approved, vouchers cannot be edited to maintain audit integrity. If changes are needed, the voucher must be cancelled and a new one created with correct details.

Q: How do I handle a bounced cheque?

A: Record a bank transaction for the reversal (reduces bank balance). Create an expense for any bank charges. Update the original income record status to "Bounced". Contact the payer for replacement payment.

Q: What if my bank reconciliation does not balance?

A: Check for: (1) Missing transactions, (2) Transactions recorded twice, (3) Wrong amounts, (4) Bank charges not recorded, (5) Deposits in transit, (6) Outstanding cheques. Document all differences and investigate each one.

Q: How do I handle cash payments for expenses?

A: Cash payments should be made from petty cash. Record the expense and link it to the petty cash account instead of the main bank account. Replenish petty cash when it runs low.

Q: Can I generate reports for previous years?

A: Yes. Select the appropriate date range when generating reports. Historical data is maintained indefinitely. For archived periods, reports may take longer to generate.

Q: How are refunds processed?

A: Refunds are recorded as negative income or as expenses depending on school policy. Create a payment voucher for the refund amount, get approval, and process payment to the recipient.

Q: What happens if the system goes down during a transaction?

A: Incomplete transactions are automatically rolled back. Check if the transaction was saved by looking at the relevant list. If not saved, re-enter the transaction.

Q: How do I add a new expense category?

A: Only the Finance Manager can add new expense categories. Navigate to Accounts ? Settings ? Expense Categories. Click "Add New", enter the category name and linked account code, then save.

Q: Why can I not approve my own payment voucher?

A: This is a security control called "segregation of duties". The person who creates a voucher cannot approve it to prevent fraud. Someone with higher authority must approve.

Q: How long are records kept in the system?

A: All financial records are retained for a minimum of 7 years as required by law. Transaction logs and audit trails are kept permanently.

14. Troubleshooting Guide

Problem	Solution
Cannot login	Check username/password. Use "Forgot Password" if needed. Contact IT after 3 failed attempts.
Page not loading	Refresh page (F5). Clear browser cache. Try different browser. Check internet connection.
Transaction not saving	Check all required fields are filled. Look for red error messages. Try again.
Report not generating	Check date range. Ensure data exists for period. Reduce date range if too large.
Bank balance incorrect	Review recent transactions. Check for unrecorded items. Run reconciliation.
Cannot approve voucher	Check your permission level. Amount may exceed your limit. Contact supervisor.
PDF not downloading	Check popup blocker settings. Try right-click "Save As". Use different browser.
Session expired	System logs out after 30 minutes of inactivity. Log in again. Save work frequently.
Duplicate transaction	Do not delete. Create reversing entry. Document the error. Record correctly.
Missing menu options	Your role may not have access. Contact Finance Manager for permission changes.

NEED HELP?

IT Support: support@stfrancis.edu.zm | Extension 101
Finance Manager: finance@stfrancis.edu.zm | Extension 105
System Admin: admin@stfrancis.edu.zm | Extension 102

15. Quick Reference

15.1 Navigation Shortcuts

To Do This...	Navigate To...
View financial overview	Accounts ? Accounts Dashboard
Record a new expense	Accounts ? Expenses ? New Expense
Create payment voucher	Accounts ? Payment Vouchers ? New
Record bank transaction	Accounts ? Bank Transactions ? New
Generate reports	Accounts ? Financial Reports
Reconcile bank account	Accounts ? Bank Reconciliation
View Chart of Accounts	Accounts ? Chart of Accounts
Manage vendors	Accounts ? Vendors
Record manual income	Accounts ? Income Records ? New

15.2 Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + S	Save current form
Ctrl + P	Print current page
Ctrl + F	Open search/filter
F5	Refresh page
Esc	Cancel/Close modal
Tab	Move to next field